

SHEELA GONJI

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SUMMARY

Technical Program Manager with extensive experience driving large-scale infrastructure migrations, platform modernization, and cross-org technical debt reduction at LinkedIn, T-Mobile, and The Home Depot. Early adopter of AI (Claude/ Glean) to modernize TPM workflows - automating readiness reviews, stakeholder communications, and ticket triage at scale. Known for building governance frameworks, leading high-complexity programs with lean teams, and delivering measurable outcomes - from 18K node data center migrations to 1,500+ job stream processing modernizations with zero downtime

EXPERIENCE

LinkedIn - Sr. Technical Program Manager

Mountain View, CA | Jan 2022 – Present

- Spearheaded strategy, planning, and execution of company-wide Horizontal Initiatives (HI) targeting technical debt reduction and operational efficiency, improving program completion success rate by 15% across 3,000+ Jira tickets every quarter
 - Defined and implemented an automated program governance (controls) framework featuring automation-first readiness reviews and centralized dashboards to optimize resource utilization and eliminate developer toil at scale.
 - Reduced HI carryover tickets by 78% (from 1,152 to 249) through structured governance, disciplined follow-up, and mandatory carryover tracking across all quarters
 - Coordinated cross-pillar migration planning across 8 engineering orgs, developing detailed LOE estimates and driving phased completion timelines to minimize disruption to H2 product roadmaps
 - Diagnosed and resolved a critical data reliability issue in the HI tracking tool, reducing batch job runtime from 3+ hours to 24 minutes - enabling on-time weekly status reports to all stakeholders
- Led data center migration and consolidation for offline data spanning 50+ systems and 18K+ nodes with zero downtime, delivered on schedule
 - Managed the end-to-end continuity of supply and resource lifecycle for an 18K+ node data center migration, utilizing internal provisioning tools to track hardware requests, allocate physical assets, and mitigate deployment bottlenecks.
- Led modernization of stream processing for 1,500+ jobs (Samza - Apache Flink) leveraging AI agents (Claude) to accelerate migration analysis, code review, and documentation — reducing latency by 27% and resource usage by 30% with a lean centralized team
 - Pioneered use of Claude-powered AI agents for TPM workflows including automated migration readiness checks, stakeholder communication drafting, and ticket triage — significantly reducing manual overhead across 3,000+ quarterly migration tickets

T-Mobile - Sr. Technical Program Manager

San Francisco, CA | Aug 2015 – Jul 2021

- Achieved resiliency for 12 applications with ~270 microservices by leading a program to build a new operational data center on a cloud-native platform
- Owned operations readiness reporting for 125+ applications, ensuring all outliers had a documented path-to-green for every release cycle
- Created Power BI dashboards for real-time visibility into release branch health metrics, deliverables, effort, progress, and blockers - eliminating manual follow-ups across engineering and business teams
- Owned and implemented an enterprise-wide Data Cleanup strategy across 12 work streams, partnering with multiple stakeholders to ensure data integrity ahead of platform launch
- Co-led quarterly Sprint planning and roadmaps for 5 teams, aligning delivery with CTO vision; co-led operations readiness for U2.0 Release launch and Market Trial

- Won the NOVA Award for analytical modeling of incidents and leading launch readiness initiatives for a billion-dollar program

AutoTrader.com - MBA Intern

Atlanta, GA | May 2014 – Aug 2014

- Developed a technology strategy that reduced operational costs by \$4M/year in the customer operations division, based on analysis of historical call data and leadership interviews
- Designed a new call logging process in Salesforce that reduced logging time by 20% and improved first-call resolution by 15%; built cross-BU reporting system to support data-driven leadership decisions

Tata Consultancy Services (Client: The Home Depot) - Project Manager / Sr. Business Analyst

Atlanta, GA | Oct 2008 – Aug 2013

- Managed data strategy for 250+ applications across DB2, Teradata, Informix, and Oracle - supporting 90% of software releases and reducing project lifecycle time by 15%
- Led product delivery for multiple releases of Inventory Logistics and Management systems, reducing product receiving time by 30%+
- Improved project execution efficiency by 20% through process improvements and structured client engagement; helped TCS expand into a new business area by delivering a high-risk cross-functional program on time
- Won Best Employee of the Month (1 of 1,500 employees) and On-the-Spot Award for best performing project lead of the year

Tata Consultancy Services - Information Technology Analyst Chennai, India | Feb 2006 – Sep 2008

- Created a searchable FAQ tool that reduced new resource onboarding time by 50%
- Performed GAP analysis and functional design reviews, identifying defects in early stages of PLC

CORE SKILLS & TOOLS

Program Management: OKR Planning, Roadmapping, Risk Management, Agile/Scrum, Capacity Planning, Budget Management (Capex /Opex)

Data & Streaming Platforms: Apache Flink, Samza

Tools & Platforms: Jira, Confluence, Power BI, GitHub

AI & Emerging Tech: Claude (Anthropic), AI Agents, Prompt Engineering, LLM-powered Workflow Automation, Agentic TPM Tooling

AI & INNOVATION

- Early adopter of Claude (Anthropic) as a TPM force-multiplier - applied AI agents to automate migration readiness reviews, draft stakeholder communications, summarize complex technical proposals, and triage large backlogs at LinkedIn
- Designed agentic workflows using Claude to reduce repetitive TPM overhead across 3,000+ quarterly HI migration tickets, cutting manual follow-up time significantly
- Leveraged AI-assisted tooling to accelerate Samza-Flink job migration analysis, enabling a lean centralized team to manage 1,500+ job migrations at scale
- Actively building skills in prompt engineering, LLM-powered workflow design, and integrating AI agents into program management and engineering operations

EDUCATION

Georgia Institute of Technology, Scheller College of Business

Atlanta, GA

Master of Business Administration (MBA)

Anna University, Electronics & Communications Engineering

Chennai, India

Bachelor of Engineering

AWARDS

- - NOVA Award (T-Mobile) - Awarded for leading launch readiness for a billion-dollar program and analytical modeling of incidents to reduce TTD/TTM
- - Best Employee of the Month (TCS) - Awarded to 1 of 1,500 employees in the account
- - On-the-Spot Award (TCS) - Best performing project lead of the year